▼ GLASSHOUSE



TEMPLE TANGO

Outfoxed yet again. On April 30, former Bengal BJP chief **Dilip Ghosh** turned up in Digha with his new bride, where TMC boss and CM **Mamata Banerjee** arranged a warm welcome at the inauguration of the Jagannath Dham temple. Never one to miss an opportunity to turn the screws on rivals, Mamata greeted the couple, posed for photos, and even went live on Facebook. Ghosh, too, was all smiles, praising her for the "big work done", but, back in Kolkata, BJP leaders were squirming. Leader of the Opposition Suvendu Adhikari offered a curt "no comment" while state chief Sukanta Majumdar rushed to clarify that Ghosh was there in a "personal capacity". Some BJP insiders saw it as Ghosh trolling his own party—particularly Adhikari, who didn't attend his wedding. As for the rumours of Ghosh jumping ship, a TMC leader smirked, "Why would we want Ghosh to join us? He's doing a splendid job fazing the BJP from within." In Bengal, politics continues to unfold with the flair of a prime-time soap opera.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ THE QUITTING GAME

CONDITIONS APPLY

A war of words between two senior Karnataka legislators has spiralled into a political farce. It began with **Basanagouda Yatnal**, recently expelled from the BJP for his shoot-from-the-hip remarks, daring Congress minister **Shivanand Patil** to resign and face him in a bypoll. Both leaders hail from Vijayapura district. Provoked, Patil took the bait and promptly submitted his resignation to the Speaker. It came, though, with a rider attached: he asked that it be accepted only if Yatnal, too, steps down from the assembly.

